

ScriptLens — PDF-to-Fountain Cleanup Guide

Purpose: Prepare Hollywood PDF screenplays for accurate ScriptLens analysis by fixing PDF extraction noise before you run the engine.

Audience: You (internal benchmark work) or anyone cleaning produced scripts for the clean benchmark corpus.

Pilot script: *Carrie* (1976 shooting script PDF) — smallest file in the current Hollywood batch.

Why cleanup matters

PDF extraction does not produce real Fountain. It usually gives you:

- **One phrase per line** — action reads like a broken list instead of paragraphs.
- **Camera slugs as standalone ALL-CAPS lines** — e.g. ANGLE, THE HOUSE, OMITTED, STELIA HORAN - DAY. The parser treats these as **character names**.
- **OCR typos** — e.g. CHIOUS instead of CHRIS, TOHMY instead of TOMMY.
- **Revision / page noise** — REVISION PAGES 51-52, bare page numbers.

ScriptLens then flags **false positives**: name consistency pairs between slug lines, and numeric-count chains across merged scene text.

Cleanup does **not** invent story fixes. It makes the file **parse correctly** so real continuity issues (if any) stand out.

What you need

Python venv	venv\Scripts\python.exe at repo root
Benchmark drop folder	tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\
Extracted Fountain (optional subfolder)	tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\
Cleanup script	scripts\cleanup_extracted_fountain.py
Batch runner	scripts\run_clean_benchmark.py
Single-script runner	run_scriptlens.py
FP review log	tests\corpus\benchmark\CLEAN_FP_LOG.md

Copyright: Do not commit PDFs or Fountain files to a public repo unless you have rights. The benchmark folder is gitignored for script files.

Step-by-step workflow

Step 1 — Drop the PDF in the benchmark folder

Copy your screenplay PDF into:

```
tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\
```

Use a sortable name, e.g. 02_carrie_1975.pdf. Double extensions like .pdf.pdf still work.

Update the inventory table in tests\corpus\benchmark\MANIFEST.md (metadata only — safe to commit).

Step 2 — Run a baseline analysis (optional but recommended)

See how noisy the raw PDF is before cleanup:

```
cd C:\Users\subhi\Documents\Subhiksha_Files\scriptlensCore

venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\run_clean_benchmark.py `
  --input-dir tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced `
  --output-dir tests\corpus\benchmark\reports
```

Open the report:

```
tests\corpus\benchmark\reports\<stem>_report.txt
```

Note **Scenes**, **Characters** (count and absurd names), and **Found N possible inconsistency(ies)**.

Step 3 — Extract PDF text to Fountain

Option A — During analysis (quick):

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe run_scriptlens.py `
  tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\02_Carrie_1975.pdf.pdf `
  --save-extracted tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carrie_1975.fountain
```

Option B — Bulk convert (if you already ran the batch):

The batch runner uses the same PDF loader internally. Copy or save extracted text to clean_produced\fountain\ for editing.

The extracted file will be **long** (one short line per phrase) and **not** writer-ready Fountain.

Step 4 — Run automated cleanup

The cleanup script reflows action into paragraphs, keeps real scene headings and character cues, and demotes common camera slugs to action text.

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\cleanup_extracted_fountain.py `
  tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carrie_1975.fountain
```

Default output: same folder, <stem>_clean.fountain

Example: 02_Carrie_1975_clean.fountain

Custom output path (optional):

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\cleanup_extracted_fountain.py `
  tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carrie_1975.fountain `
  tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carrie_1975_v2.fountain
```

What the script does automatically:

Split scene headings (INT. on one line, location on the next)	Merges into one INT. ... - DAY line
Action split across many short lines	Joins into action paragraphs

STELIA
(at something of a loss) Well, I'm a good girl.

If dialogue is stuck in an action paragraph without a cue, split it: cue line, then dialogue.

5d. Remove or inline revision markers

Delete standalone lines like:

REVISION PAGES 51-52
OMITTED

If OMITTED marks a cut scene, remove the block or replace with a brief action note in sentence case.

5e. Save as your “analysis copy”

Keep the cleaned file separate from the raw extract:

02_Carie_1975.fountain	← raw extract (keep for diff)
02_Carie_1975_clean.fountain	← after automated cleanup
02_Carie_1975_manual.fountain	← optional: after your manual pass

Step 6 — Re-run ScriptLens on the cleaned file

Single script (full report to terminal):

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe run_scriptlens.py `
tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carie_1975_clean.fountain
```

Save report to file:

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe run_scriptlens.py `
tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain\02_Carie_1975_clean.fountain `
| Out-File -Encoding utf8 `
tests\corpus\benchmark\reports\fountain_clean\02_Carie_1975_clean_report.txt
```

Batch (only cleaned files in a folder):

Put *_clean.fountain files alone in a folder, then:

```
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\run_clean_benchmark.py `
--input-dir tests\corpus\benchmark\clean_produced\fountain `
--output-dir tests\corpus\benchmark\reports\fountain_clean
```

(If raw and cleaned files share a folder, the batch will analyse both — use a subfolder or rename filter by moving files.)

Step 7 — Compare before/after and log false positives

Compare these fields in the report header:

Characters	Should drop sharply (fewer slug “names”)
name_consistency flags	Should drop (slug pairs removed)

numeric_count flags	May stay or increase — see note below
Overall health score	May stay low until flag count is low

Log your verdicts in `tests\corpus\benchmark\CLEAN_FP_LOG.md`:

- **FP** — engine wrong; PDF/cleanup artifact
- **Real** — surprising catch on a clean script (rare)
- **Unsure** — needs second read

Carrie pilot — before vs after automated cleanup

Scenes	82	82
Character names parsed	267	98
Total contradiction flags	13	15
name_consistency	6	1
numeric_count	7	14

Interpretation:

- **Big win:** Slug false names (`THE HOUSE` vs `THE HOSE`, `CARRIE AND TOMMY` vs `TOHMY`, `OMITTED` variants) mostly gone — character list is usable.
- **Remaining name flag:** `CHRIS` vs `CHIU` — OCR typo; fix manually in Step 5b.
- **numeric_count increased:** Reflowing merges more words into each scene, so word-count chains (`group`, `ext`, `continued`, `carrie`) fire more often. Treat these as **noise** on PDF-derived scripts unless you see an obvious story mistake.
- **Next step for Carrie:** Manual pass (Step 5) then re-run; expect `name_consistency` → 0 and slightly better character count.

Quick reference — all commands

```
# 1. Baseline batch
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\run_clean_benchmark.py

# 2. PDF → Fountain extract
venv\Scripts\python.exe run_scriptlens.py path\to\script.pdf `
  --save-extracted path\to\script.fountain

# 3. Automated cleanup
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\cleanup_extracted_fountain.py path\to\script.fountain

# 4. Analyse cleaned file
venv\Scripts\python.exe run_scriptlens.py path\to\script_clean.fountain

# 5. External scripts folder (copyright-safe)
venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\run_clean_benchmark.py `
  --input-dir "C:\path\to\hollywood_clean" `
```

```
--output-dir tests\corpus\benchmark\reports
```

Troubleshooting

Hundreds of “characters” like <code>ANGLE,</code> <code>THE GYM</code>	Slug lines parsed as cues	Run cleanup script + manual demote (Step 5a)
Same person flagged twice (<code>CHRIS /</code> <code>CHIUS</code>)	OCR typo in cue line	Fix spelling in Step 5b
Flags unchanged PDF vs Fountain	Fountain is same extract as PDF path	Cleanup + manual edit required
<code>numeric_count</code> only flags	Word-count detector on merged action	Usually FP on PDF scripts; log as FP
Scene count seems wrong	Split/merged headings	Fix <code>INT.</code> / <code>EXT.</code> lines at scene breaks
Health score 0 / 100	Many flags depress score	Normal for unclean PDFs; focus on flag types

Files produced by this workflow

<code>clean_produced/*.pdf</code>	No (gitignored)
<code>clean_produced/fountain/*.fountain</code>	No (gitignored)
<code>reports/*_report.txt</code>	No (gitignored)
<code>MANIFEST.md</code> , <code>CLEAN_FP_LOG.md</code>	Yes (metadata / review)
This guide (<code>.md</code> / <code>.pdf</code>)	Yes

Related docs

- Benchmark README: `tests/corpus/benchmark/README.md`
- Corpus evaluation: `docs/CORPUS_EVALUATION_GUIDE.md`
- Writer error examples: `docs/writer_materials/ERROR_TYPE_EXAMPLES_GUIDE.pdf`

ScriptLens — internal benchmark workflow. Last updated: June 2026.